# Travel and Expenses Policy

Fictional sample document for this PoC; not a real policy.

## 1. Purpose and responsibilities

The company reimburses reasonable, approved costs incurred while carrying out company work. This fictional policy applies to employees who travel for business or buy eligible work equipment. All amounts are in Singapore dollars, written as SGD. Finance owns the expense process and maintains the claim form. A budget owner is the manager responsible for the cost centre charged on that form. Personal purchases do not become business expenses simply because they were made during a business trip.

Employees should use the least costly practical option that meets the business need. They must keep an itemised receipt showing the supplier, transaction date, items purchased, and total paid. A credit-card statement alone is insufficient when an itemised receipt is available. If a receipt is lost, the employee explains the circumstances and requests a written exception from Finance before submitting the claim. Employees may not approve their own expenses.

## 2. Business travel

### 2.1 Advance approval

The line manager and budget owner must approve overnight business travel before any booking is made. Submit the itinerary, business purpose, estimated transport costs, and expected accommodation costs at least 7 calendar days before departure.

Economy class is the standard for flights and rail travel. A change of class requires written approval from the Finance Director before purchase. Employees should compare practical routes rather than selecting a cheaper route that prevents attendance at the planned meeting. Any personal extension to a trip must be identified in advance; additional personal accommodation and transport costs are paid by the employee. Security requirements for taking a laptop abroad are covered by the Information Security Policy.

### 2.2 Meals and accommodation

Meals during approved overnight business travel are reimbursable up to SGD 65 per person per day, including taxes and service charges. Alcohol and meals already included in a hotel or event booking are not reimbursable.

The daily meal allowance is a cap on actual spending, not an automatic cash payment. Hotel accommodation is capped at SGD 220 per room per night before taxes. A higher hotel rate requires the Finance Director's written approval before booking, supported by evidence that suitable rooms are unavailable within the cap. Employees record each meal separately and attach receipts. Team meals must identify the attendees and the business purpose so Finance can avoid duplicate claims.

## 3. Expense claims

### 3.1 Submission deadline

Submit expense claims within 30 calendar days after the purchase date or, for business travel, within 30 calendar days after returning. The line manager reviews the claim before Finance checks the receipts and pays approved claims in the next scheduled monthly expense run.

Claims must state the cost centre and include any advance approval. Foreign-currency claims include the original amount, currency, and the exchange rate shown on the payment record. Finance can return incomplete claims for correction; a returned claim is not an approval. Employees should respond to questions within five working days. An overdue claim requires a written explanation and approval from the Finance Manager before it can enter the normal payment process.

### 3.2 Home-office reimbursement

An employee may claim up to SGD 400 for eligible home-office equipment in a rolling 24-month period. The line manager must approve the purchase in advance, and the employee must attach itemised receipts to the expense claim.

Eligible items are a desk, an ergonomic chair, a monitor, a keyboard, and a mouse. The cap covers the combined cost of those items, including delivery and taxes. Internet subscriptions, rent, utilities, decorative items, and extended consumer warranties are excluded. Finance maintains the remaining allowance balance. The Remote Work Policy determines whether an employee is eligible to work remotely and whether a workspace is suitable; that approval does not itself approve an equipment claim.

## 4. Reviews and corrections

Finance may ask for supporting information when a claim is unclear or duplicates an earlier submission. The employee's manager helps resolve business-purpose questions but cannot waive receipt requirements without Finance approval. If an employee discovers an overpayment, they notify Finance within five working days. Finance agrees a correction with the employee and records the reason in the claim history rather than asking for an undocumented cash repayment.

Suspected deliberate misrepresentation is referred to the reporting process in the Code of Conduct. Honest mistakes should be corrected promptly and do not automatically constitute misconduct. Finance reviews this policy annually and publishes updated caps with an effective date. A purchase is assessed against the cap in force when it was approved, so staff should retain approval records with their receipts.